

ELYMAR APAO

UX & Product Design Lead | Fintech & Payments | Design Systems | MBA Candidate
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SUMMARY

UX design leader with **15+ years driving product experience for fintech, consumer finance, and digital platforms**. Proven track record of owning the full design process — user research, wireframing, prototyping, hi-fidelity UI, design systems — and building the team and processes that sustain quality at scale. At Home Credit Philippines, I led a 16-person design organization serving 11 million customers, architected an enterprise Design System that reduced rework by 30%, and drove platform growth from under 2M to 45M+ page views. I thrive in English-first, multicultural, remote-first environments and have the cross-functional communication skills to partner tightly with engineers and PMs in distributed teams. Currently completing a Full-Time MBA at GLOBIS University in Tokyo.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Payments & Fintech UX	Design Systems & Process	Team Building & Cross-functional Leadership
Consumer finance & payment flow design	Figma governance & component libraries	UX team hiring, mentoring & career development
Trust, reliability & accessibility design	Design-to-engineering handoff standards	Design sprint facilitation (20+ delivered)
User research & usability testing	Responsive & mobile-first design	Cross-functional PM + engineering partnership

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

HOME CREDIT PHILIPPINES — Online Department

Manila, Philippines | Feb 2022 – Jul 2025 *Senior User Experience Designer / Design Lead (Consumer Finance Platform, 11M+ customers)*

- **Led a 16-person design organization** — UX designers, researchers, and content specialists — establishing career frameworks, design mentorship, and quality standards across 50+ concurrent product initiatives.
- **Architected and drove enterprise Design System adoption** — Figma governance, component libraries, and design-to-development handoff standards — reducing rework by **30%** and enabling consistent, fast iteration across a large consumer finance platform.
- **Owned end-to-end UX for high-stakes financial flows** — loan origination, customer self-service, and acquisition funnels — applying trust-centered design principles to a platform where reliability and clarity directly affect user confidence and conversion.
- **Drove platform traffic from <2M to 45M+ page views (500% growth)**, contributing to a **47% YoY increase in net earning assets** through user-research-informed experience improvements and SEO-driven growth design.

JG SUMMIT HOLDINGS INC. — Digital Transformation Office

Manila, Philippines | Jun 2018 – Aug 2021 *Customer Experience Head / Design Strategy Lead (Conglomerate, 6 Business Units)*

- **Built and led a cross-functional design and research team from zero** across banking, retail, property, and manufacturing — defining experience principles, governance standards, and design systems that reduced product development cycles by up to **25%**.
- **Delivered 20+ discovery-to-delivery design sprints**, translating complex multi-stakeholder needs into validated UX strategies and shipped product features, including merchant and B2B-facing digital experiences.
- **Mentored innovation teams** that generated **₱10M (~¥26M) in new revenue in six months** and sustained 80%+ CSAT — evidence that design-led product development produces measurable business results.

GOODWALL.IO

Geneva, Switzerland (Remote) | Jan 2018 – May 2018 *Product Manager (Global EdTech / Career Platform Startup)*

- **Worked fully remote in a globally distributed team** across Europe and Asia — proof of async communication, documentation discipline, and multicultural collaboration in an English-first environment.
- **Translated product vision into prioritized UX and roadmap decisions** working directly with founders in a fast-moving, high-ambiguity startup.

PROUDCLOUD & MASHUP GARAGE — Digital Agency

Quezon City, Philippines | Nov 2016 – Jul 2017 *Experience & Product Consultant — Web/App Engagements*

- **Ran rapid design sprints** for multiple concurrent web and mobile clients — delivered validated product concepts and established repeatable design-led development workflows.

OLX PHILIPPINES (a NASPERS Company)

Philippines | Sep 2013 – Apr 2016 *User Experience Manager (Global Marketplace Platform)*

- **Established user research pipelines, analytics interpretation, and usability testing practices** for a high-traffic consumer marketplace — building evidence-driven design culture across a global team.
- **Designed and delivered Design Thinking curriculum** adopted by Naspers in Singapore and Dubai — trained 200+ employees in research-led, human-centered product thinking.

US AUTO PARTS PHILIPPINES INC. — E-commerce Platform

Philippines | Sep 2007 – Oct 2013 *Product Development & Experience Manager*

- **Designed and launched SEO and growth-driven e-commerce experiences** generating 50–100 daily sales — built a data-informed, iterative approach to experience optimization as the team's core growth engine.

EARLIER CAREER

Roles in product management, marketing, and education technology at AmphilTech, YoYo Holdings (Singapore-registered, Japanese-managed), Webcast Technologies, EduQuest, and Ateneo Grade School. Highlights include early SEO and product programs, cross-cultural facilitation with Japanese-managed organizations, and education platform design.

EDUCATION

MBA Candidate — Full-Time (Strategy, Innovation & Finance focus)

GLOBIS University, Graduate School of Management — Tokyo, Japan | 2025 – 2026

Coursework: Entrepreneurial Leadership, Customer Journey & Branding, Strategic Reorganization, Leading Global Virtual Teams, Venture Capital & Finance, Business Presentation

B.A. Economics

Ateneo De Manila University (ADMU) — Quezon City, Philippines | 1991 – 1995

LANGUAGES

Languages: English (Native) · Filipino (Native) · Japanese (Beginner — actively studying)

COMMUNITY & RECOGNITION

- **Founder, UX Philippines** — pioneered the product design community in the Philippines (bit.ly/uxphhistory); 10+ years of design advocacy and community building.
- **GLOBIS MBA Ambassador (2025–2026)** — full-time cohort representative; speaking, content, peer mentorship.
- **AFSJ Dunong 2026 Speaker** — presented on AI × Entrepreneurship at the Filipino student community in Japan.